

the Bundahish, as based on the Dâmdât Nask, and confirmed in important respects by Plutarch, justifies us in depending on it: we remember also how independent astronomical tests have assigned it an epoch as early as 40 A.D.¹ An Avestan guarantee is available for the parallel between Yima's *Var* and the Jerusalem of Rev. 21.² More important is the mention in Rev. 1⁴ of "the seven Spirits which are before [God's] throne." This answers closely to the form of the Amshaspand doctrine in which the number seven is made up without including Ahura Mazdah; and it is significant that the same form appears in *Tobit*, which we find to be based largely on Magian folk-story. Extra-canonical works like *Enoch* supply a larger fund of parallels. A quotation from Clemen's summary will put in short compass the points in which an acute outside observer of Parsism thinks the imagery of Jewish-Christian apocalyptic traceable to this outside source:³

The idea of the Son of Man comes ultimately from Parsism,⁴ and the speculation in this system regarding the Primal Man⁵ probably lurks behind such passages as 1 Cor. 15⁴⁵ ff. and Phil. 2⁶ f. But, more important than this, the expectation of a future triumph over the devil,⁶ of a

¹ See above, p. 26 f.

² See p. 308, and *ERPP*, 156.

³ *Primitive Christianity*, 368 (E.T.).

⁴ P. 154-6. None of the evidence is early, and at the most can only affect externals.

⁵ *Ib.* The extent to which Yima and Adam approximate is indicated above.

⁶ P. 160. This point, as far as imagery goes, was admitted above. There is not the slightest reason to assert a historical connexion between the two religions in their optimist outlook as a whole: cf. p. 155 f. above.